



Fluent in Tech

Program guide · Leadership coaching

# Leadership Program for International Tech Leaders

A 10–12 week one-to-one leadership journey for managers and senior professionals ready to step into — or accelerate — senior leadership roles.

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DURATION

**10–12 weeks**

STRUCTURE

**8 modules + capstone**

INVESTMENT

**\$135 / session**

[fluentintechcoaching.com/leadership-coaching](https://fluentintechcoaching.com/leadership-coaching)

## Leadership, culture and communication – together.

This program is built for professionals in technology who work in English as a second or third language and are ready for senior leadership. It addresses the intersection of cultural identity, communication and career advancement that standard leadership programs often overlook.

You leave with a clear leadership identity, sharper executive presence, stronger stakeholder relationships and a concrete career strategy built on your strengths as a global professional.

### Who it's for

- Engineering, product, data, design or operations leaders at manager level and above
- Non-native English speakers working in a largely Western tech culture
- High-potential leaders preparing for Director, VP or C-suite roles
- Leaders who want to lead authentically – cultural background and all

### At a glance

- **Format:** one-to-one sessions of 60–75 minutes each week
- **Delivery:** online; recordings by agreement
- **Assessments:** cultural values, cultural intelligence, 360° feedback and leadership style (optional)
- **Capstone:** a real leadership project in weeks 9–10
- **After:** a 90-day accountability plan

### What you'll achieve

- A confident leadership identity that integrates your cultural background
- Measurably stronger executive communication, presence and influence in senior settings
- Fluency in the unwritten rules of Western tech culture – adapting without losing yourself
- A career roadmap with a 1-, 3- and 5-year vision and concrete next steps
- A completed capstone project that shows your leadership growth in practice
- A resilience framework for the long game of senior leadership

### THE CURRICULUM

## Three phases, twelve weeks.

### Phase 1 • Foundation

WEEKS 1–4

Self-awareness, communication confidence, cultural fluency and strategic influence.

| WEEK | THEME                                               | IN THE SESSION                                                                                                                                | BETWEEN SESSIONS                                                                                                              |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WK 1 | <b>Identity mapping</b><br>Who are you as a leader? | Cultural values assessment; strengths inventory – what you bring that others don't; the “two worlds” exercise; defining your leadership brand | Write “My leadership story” in 500 words; name three moments your background was an advantage; start a daily 5-minute journal |

| WEEK | THEME                                                                           | IN THE SESSION                                                                                                            | BETWEEN SESSIONS                                                                                                             |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WK 2 | <b>Communication power &amp; presence</b><br>Being heard in every room          | Video analysis of your style; PAR for concise storytelling; accent and authenticity; assertive vs. aggressive vs. passive | Record a 3-minute introduction; prepare PAR answers for five executive scenarios; speak first in two meetings                |
| WK 3 | <b>Tech culture &amp; unwritten rules</b><br>What the org chart doesn't say     | Directness and flat hierarchies; candid feedback; humor, small talk and informal relationships; power in hybrid teams     | Map your organization's informal power structure; have one coffee chat with a senior stakeholder; note three unwritten rules |
| WK 4 | <b>Influence &amp; stakeholders</b><br>Leading up, across and beyond your title | Influence vs. interest mapping; self-advocacy scripts for reviews; managing up; sponsors vs. mentors                      | Complete your stakeholder map; draft review talking points; reach out to one potential sponsor                               |

## Phase 2 · Amplification

WEEKS 5-8

Executive presence, cross-cultural leadership, career strategy and resilience.

| WEEK | THEME                                                                       | IN THE SESSION                                                                                                                     | BETWEEN SESSIONS                                                                                                         |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WK 5 | <b>Executive presence</b><br>Owning high-stakes moments                     | Presence audit — body language, voice, pacing; pitching your ideas; a simulated executive presentation; handling hostile questions | Deliver a recorded 5-minute executive update; prepare answers to ten tough questions; choose one high-stakes opportunity |
| WK 6 | <b>Cross-cultural team leadership</b><br>Diversity as a strength            | Cultural intelligence assessment; conflict role-plays; psychological safety; inclusive meeting facilitation                        | Hold 1:1s through a cultural lens; try one new inclusive practice; reflect on a past conflict                            |
| WK 7 | <b>Career architecture &amp; visibility</b><br>Designing your next move     | 1-, 3- and 5-year goals; LinkedIn and executive presence audit; internal and external visibility; navigating bias                  | Write a one-page career vision; update LinkedIn; pick one speaking or thought-leadership opportunity                     |
| WK 8 | <b>Resilience &amp; sustainable leadership</b><br>Leading for the long game | The cost of code-switching; boundaries and recovery; your personal board of directors; integrating your identity at work           | Complete an energy audit; hold one wellbeing boundary for two weeks; name your personal board (3-5 people)               |

Lead in real time with a capstone project, then launch your next chapter.

| WEEK     | THEME                              | IN THE SESSION                                                                                                              | BETWEEN SESSIONS                                                                                             |
|----------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WK 9–10  | <b>Capstone leadership project</b> | Define a real business challenge; weekly coaching on execution and stakeholders; a mid-point review of progress and pivots  | Execute the project against weekly milestones; document decisions and outcomes; prepare a final presentation |
| WK 11–12 | <b>Integration &amp; launch</b>    | Capstone presentation and debrief; writing your personal leadership manifesto; a short 360° feedback loop; forward planning | Finalize your 1–2 page manifesto; set 90-day goals with an accountability partner                            |

#### COACHING PHILOSOPHY

## Your background is a leadership asset.

The program is strengths-based and identity-affirming. Your language, your worldview and your experience of navigating several cultures are not liabilities to manage — they are assets to use.

### Identity integration

You don't change who you are. You bring more of yourself — confidently and strategically — into your leadership.

### Cultural intelligence

You adapt without assimilating, and lead across cultures without losing yourself.

### Strategic execution

Every insight connects to a concrete action. Here, we build, do and measure.

### How progress is measured

- Self-assessment across eight leadership competencies, before and after
- Optional 360° feedback from your manager, peers and direct reports
- A weekly reflection journal, discussed in sessions
- The capstone project, judged against success criteria agreed up front
- A 90-day check-in after the program

### Recommended reading

- *The Culture Map* — Erin Meyer
- *Presence* — Amy Cuddy
- *Authentic Diversity* — Michelle Silverthorn
- *Dare to Lead* — Brené Brown
- *The Making of a Manager* — Julie Zhuo

## INVESTMENT

# Pricing and getting started.

### One-to-one

**\$135** / session

Weekly 60–75 minute sessions. Most clients follow the full 10–12 week arc; others focus on one transition or one important meeting.

### Getting started

1. A free consultation to check the fit and set goals
2. An intake questionnaire
3. Choose assessments and agree success measures
4. Book your first session

Programs start on a rolling basis. For groups, the Leadership Circle cohort and private team cohorts are available — see Programs on the website.

**“Your accent is not a barrier. It is evidence of the worlds you’ve navigated to get here. Now let’s make sure the rest of the room knows it too.”**

— Mark Parfenov

## NEXT STEP

# Start with a free call.

Tell Mark where you are now, where you want to be and what’s in the way. You’ll leave the call with a clear recommendation — whether or not you decide to work together.

#### BOOK

[fluentintechcoaching.com/book](https://fluentintechcoaching.com/book)

#### EMAIL

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#### PRICING

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